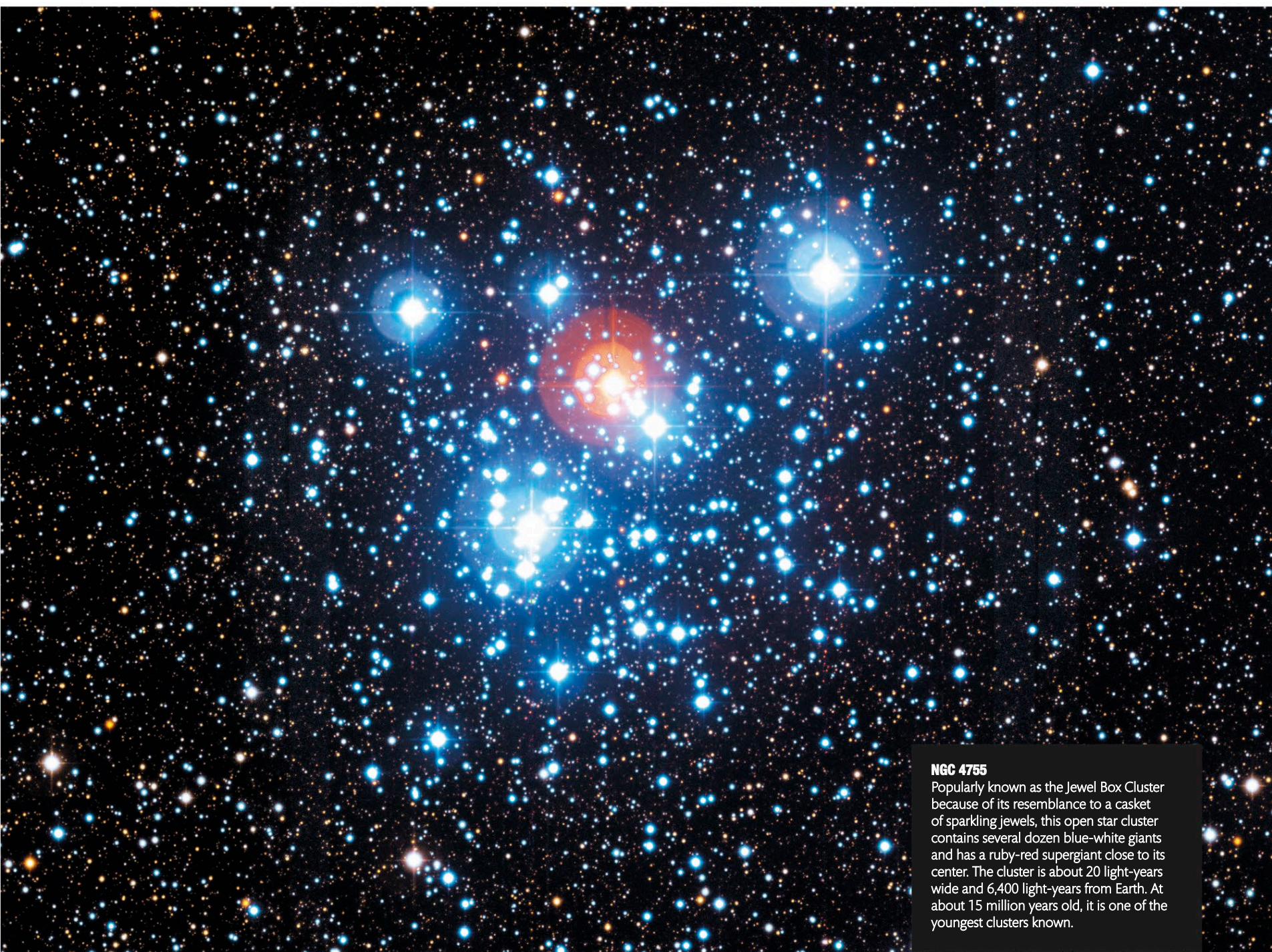


Delta Crucis
750 Suns

Mimosa
2,010 Suns

Acrux
4180 Suns



NGC 4755

Popularly known as the Jewel Box Cluster because of its resemblance to a casket of sparkling jewels, this open star cluster contains several dozen blue-white giants and has a ruby-red supergiant close to its center. The cluster is about 20 light-years wide and 6,400 light-years from Earth. At about 15 million years old, it is one of the youngest clusters known.

► **Star distances**

Three of Crux's four pattern stars lie at similar distances from Earth: Mimosa at 278 light-years, Acrux at 322 light-years, and Delta (δ) Crucis at 345 light-years. Gacrux, marking the northern end of the cross, is the constellation's nearest pattern star. In fact, at only at 89 light-years away, it is also one of the nearest known red giants.

